Chapter 43 — Personalization & User-Preference Sync

> **Part V — Shared & Global State** · Complexity: **Standard** (≥25 interview questions)
>
> **Prerequisites:** Ch 4 (DataStore), Ch 29–33 (sync/conflict), Ch 42 (per-account), Ch 39 (global state), Ch 41 (remote config — contrast). Completes **Part V**.
>
> **Reference surface in StreamCart:** a user's settings (theme, autoplay, data-saver, notification prefs) and personalization (preferred categories, content filters) following them **across devices** — set on the phone, reflected on the tablet and TV.

43.1 Problem Definition and Real-World Context

Users expect their **preferences** (settings) and **personalization** (tastes, filters, "for you" signals) to **follow them across devices** — change the theme or content filters on the phone and have the tablet/TV honor them. This is a specialized sync problem (Ch 29–33) with its own characteristics, and naive handling frustrates users or leaks data:

- **Device-local only.** Preferences stored only in DataStore (Ch 4) don't sync — the user re-configures every device. Fine for device-specific settings (text size per screen), wrong for account-level preferences.
- **No precedence model.** With defaults, local edits, and synced values all in play, which wins? Without a clear **default < synced < local-unsynced** precedence (and conflict handling), devices show inconsistent prefs.
- **Preference conflicts.** The user changes a pref on two devices while offline; simple-but-wrong handling loses one change. Preferences need a conflict policy (usually LWW per key, Ch 33) — but some are mergeable (a *set* of muted topics).
- **Device-scoped vs account-scoped confusion.** Some settings are **device-specific** (don't sync: per-device text size, this-device notifications) and some are **account-level** (sync: theme, content filters). Syncing the wrong ones is annoying or wrong.
- **Privacy.** Personalization signals are sensitive (reveal interests/behavior); syncing/analytics must honor consent and minimize data.

The architecture: model preferences with a clear **precedence** (defaults → synced → local unsynced), store **device-scoped** prefs locally (DataStore, Ch 4) and **account-scoped** prefs in a **synced store** (offline-first, Ch 29; delta sync, Ch 32) with **per-key conflict resolution** (Ch 33, usually LWW or set-merge), scoped **per account** (Ch 42), consumed as **global state** (Ch 39), and **privacy-aware**. This chapter is about **syncing user preferences correctly across devices**.

Three practical use cases

1. **Cross-device settings (StreamCart).** Theme, autoplay, data-saver, and notification topic preferences set on the phone apply on the tablet and TV.

2. **Personalization (OTT).** Preferred genres, content filters (hide spoilers, maturity level), and "not interested" signals follow the user across devices.
3. **Accessibility (all).** A user's accessibility preferences (captions on, reduced motion) sync so every device is configured once.

Why this is architectural

Preference sync defines **which state is device- vs account-scoped**, the **precedence and conflict model** for settings, the **offline-first sync** of account preferences, and the **privacy** handling of personalization signals — properties that determine whether users get a coherent, cross-device experience.

43.2 Requirements Engineering

Functional requirements

ID	Requirement
F1	Store device-scoped prefs locally (don't sync); account-scoped prefs sync across devices.
F2	Clear precedence: default < synced < local-unsynced (optimistic).
F3	Sync account preferences offline-first (Ch 29) with delta (Ch 32).
F4	Resolve preference conflicts per key (LWW, or set-merge for collections, Ch 33).
F5	Scope preferences per account (Ch 42).
F6	Expose preferences as observable global state (Ch 39); apply instantly.
F7	Honor consent/privacy for personalization signals.

Non-functional requirements

Attribute	Policy
Consistency	Coherent prefs across devices (eventual); clear precedence.
Availability	Prefs editable offline; apply immediately.
Correctness	Per-key conflict resolution; no lost changes.
Privacy	Personalization signals consented, minimized, encrypted if sensitive.
UX	Instant local apply; cross-device follow-through.

Scope

- **In scope:** device- vs account-scoped prefs, precedence model, offline-first pref sync + per-key conflict resolution, per-account scoping, global-state exposure, personalization-signal privacy.
- **Out of scope:** the sync engine internals (Ch 29–33), remote config/flags (Ch 41 — server-controlled, different from user prefs), DataStore basics (Ch 4), recommendation algorithms (backend/Ch 73).

Assumptions & constraints

- DataStore for device-scoped (Ch 4); a synced account-pref store (offline-first, Ch 29/32/33); per-account (Ch 42). Backend stores account preferences. `minSdk 24`. **User preferences ≠ remote config** (user-controlled vs server-controlled).

43.3 System Design Fundamentals

- **Device- vs account-scoped preferences.** The key classification:
  - **Device-scoped** (don't sync): settings meaningful to *this device* — per-device text size, this-device notification channels, cache location. Stored in local DataStore (Ch 4).
  - **Account-scoped** (sync): settings/personalization belonging to the *user* — theme, autoplay, content filters, preferred genres, accessibility. Stored in a synced store, following the user across devices. Misclassifying causes "my phone's text size changed my TV" (annoying) or "my content filters didn't follow me" (wrong).
- **Precedence model.** When reading a preference, resolve in order: **local unsynced edit** (optimistic, most recent user intent) → **synced value** (from the server/ other devices) → **default** (compiled-in). This ensures the user's latest change wins locally while syncing, and defaults cover gaps.
- **Offline-first pref sync (Ch 29).** Account prefs are edited **optimistically** (apply instantly locally), queued (outbox, Ch 31), and synced (delta, Ch 32) — just like any offline-first data. The user never waits to change a setting.
- **Per-key conflict resolution (Ch 33).** Preferences conflict when edited on two devices. Most are **scalar → LWW per key** (latest timestamp/version wins, Ch 33) — simple and acceptable (losing an older toggle is fine). Some are **collections** (muted topics, "not interested" items) → **set-merge/OR-Set CRDT** (Ch 33) so adds/removes from both devices survive. Resolve **per key**, not whole- blob (whole-blob LWW loses concurrent edits to different settings).
- **Personalization signals.** "For you" data (viewed/liked/skipped, preferred categories) is a special pref class: often **account-scoped, synced, privacy- sensitive**, and feeds backend recommendations (Ch 73). Treat with consent + data minimization.
- **Global-state exposure (Ch 39).** Preferences are read app-wide (theme, filters) → exposed via a `PreferencesRepository` holder as observable global state; changes apply instantly everywhere.
- **User prefs vs remote config (Ch 41).** Opposite control: **user preferences** are **user-controlled** (the user sets them, they sync to the user's account); **remote config/flags** are **server-controlled** (the operator sets them, rolled out to clients). Don't conflate — a user toggling autoplay is a preference; the operator enabling a new feature is a flag.

Core insight: **classify each preference as device- or account-scoped, apply account prefs offline-first with per-key conflict resolution (LWW for scalars, set-merge for collections), resolve reads by precedence (local-unsynced → synced → default), scope per account, expose as global state, and keep personalization signals private** — so preferences follow the user across devices correctly.

43.4 High-Level Architecture



Components & ownership

- **Classification** routes each pref to device-local (DataStore) or account-synced (Room offline-first).
- **Account pref sync** reuses offline-first/outbox/delta/conflict (Ch 29–33), per-account (Ch 42).
- `PreferencesRepository` exposes resolved prefs as global state (Ch 39) by precedence.
- **Consent** gates syncing/using personalization signals.

Direction: edit → classify → device-local or account-synced → read by precedence → apply app-wide; account prefs sync across devices with per-key conflict resolution.

43.5 Detailed Component Design

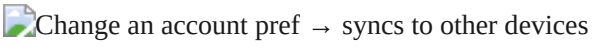


Pref	Scope	Sync?	Conflict (Ch 33)
theme	account	✅	LWW
autoplay / data-saver	account	✅	LWW
this-device notifications	device	❌	n/a
per-device text size	device	❌	n/a
muted topics / "not interested"	account	✅	set-merge (OR-Set)
preferred genres	account	✅	set-merge / LWW

> **Per-key resolution matters:** store prefs as **individual keyed entries** (not one blob) so device A changing theme and device B changing autoplay both survive — a whole-blob LWW would lose one.

43.6 End-to-End Data Flow

Change an account pref → syncs to other devices



Read precedence



43.7 Complete Kotlin Implementation

Package: `com.streamcart.data.preferences`.

43.7.1 Device- vs account-scoped stores

```
// DEVICE-scoped: local only, never synced (Ch 4).
class DevicePreferences @Inject constructor(private val store: DataStore<Preferences>) {
    val textScale: Flow<Float> = store.data.map { it[floatPreferencesKey("text_scale")] ?: 1.0f
}
    suspend fun setTextScale(v: Float) = store.edit { it[floatPreferencesKey("text_scale")] = v
}.let {}
}

// ACCOUNT-scoped: synced, per-account (Ch 42), offline-first (Ch 29), per-key entries.
@Entity(tableName = "account_prefs", primaryKeys = ["accountId","key"])
data class PreferenceEntry(
    val accountId: String, val key: String, val value: String,
    val updatedAt: Long, val version: Long = 0,
    val syncStatus: SyncStatus = SyncStatus.PENDING,
)
```

43.7.2 PreferencesRepository (precedence, global state, optimistic sync)

```
@Singleton
class PreferencesRepository @Inject constructor(
    private val device: DevicePreferences,
    private val dao: AccountPrefDao,
    private val accounts: AccountProvider,            // per-account (Ch 42)
    private val outbox: OutboxDao,                    // Ch 31
    private val syncScheduler: SyncScheduler,         // Ch 30
    private val clock: Clock,
) {
    private val defaults = mapOf("theme" to "System", "autoplay" to "true")

    // Precedence: synced store already holds the latest (local-unsynced is reflected
    // optimistically in the same store); fall back to default.
    val theme: Flow<Theme> = accountPref("theme").map { Theme.valueOf(it ?: defaults["theme"]!!)
}

    private fun accountPref(key: String): Flow<String?> =
        accounts.currentId.filterNotNull()
            .flatMapLatest { acct -> dao.observe(acct, key) }    // account-scoped (Ch 42)
            .map { it?.value }

    suspend fun setTheme(theme: Theme) = setAccountPref("theme", theme.name)   // account-
scoped, syncs

    private suspend fun setAccountPref(key: String, value: String) {
        val acct = accounts.currentIdValue()
        val entry = PreferenceEntry(acct, key, value, clock.now(), version = nextVersion(acct,
key), syncStatus = SyncStatus.PENDING)
        dao.upsert(entry)                                // optimistic (applies instantly, Ch 29)
        outbox.insert(mutation("pref.set", "$acct:$key", json(entry)))   // Ch 31
        syncScheduler.requestSync()                      // Ch 30
    }

    // Collection pref: set-merge (OR-Set, Ch 33).
    suspend fun addMutedTopic(topic: String) {
        val cur = currentMutedTopics()
        setAccountPref("muted_topics", json(cur + topic))   // merged on conflict (Ch 33)
    }
}
```

43.7.3 Per-key conflict resolution (Ch 33)

```
class PrefConflictResolver @Inject constructor(private val json: Json) {
    fun resolve(key: String, base: PreferenceEntry?, local: PreferenceEntry?, remote:
PreferenceEntry): PreferenceEntry =
        when {
            isCollection(key) -> remote.copy(value = mergeSets(local?.value, remote.value,
base?.value))  // OR-Set
            local == null || remote.version > local.version -> remote
// LWW
            remote.version < local.version -> local
            else -> if (remote.updatedAt >= local.updatedAt) remote else local
// ts tiebreak
        }
    private fun isCollection(key: String) = key in setOf("muted_topics", "preferred_genres")
}
```

43.7.4 Personalization signal with consent

```
suspend fun recordNotInterested(itemId: String, consent: ConsentManager) {
    if (!consent.personalizationAllowed()) return       // honor consent (privacy)
    addToAccountSet("not_interested", itemId)           // account-scoped, synced, feeds recs
(Ch 73)
}
```

43.7.5 Module structure

```
:data:preferences  DevicePreferences (Ch 4), PreferencesRepository (global state Ch 39),
                   AccountPrefDao, PrefConflictResolver (Ch 33)
:sync              pref sync via offline-first (Ch 29-32), per-account (Ch 42)
```

43.8 Concurrency and Race Conditions

Scenario	Risk	Handling
Same pref edited on two devices	lost change	per-key LWW / set-merge (Ch 33)
Different prefs edited concurrently	one blob overwrites	per-key entries (not a blob)
Edit during sync	overwrite local	version + outbox (Ch 31); conflict resolve (Ch 33)
Device vs account misclassification	wrong device affected	classify correctly; device prefs never sync
Account switch mid-edit	wrong account's pref	account-scoped + `flatMapLatest` (Ch 42)
Default vs synced precedence	wrong value	local-unsynced → synced → default

- **Per-key entries + per-key conflict resolution** is the correctness crux: it lets concurrent edits to *different* prefs both survive and handles same-pref conflicts by policy — a whole-blob approach loses one side.
- **Account scoping (Ch 42)** ensures prefs edited for account A don't bleed into B.

43.9 Failure Scenarios and Recovery

Failure	Detection	Response	Outcome
Offline edit	connectivity	optimistic local + outbox (Ch 31)	applies; syncs later
Concurrent device edit (scalar)	version	LWW (Ch 33)	latest wins (acceptable)
Concurrent device edit (collection)	version	set-merge (Ch 33)	both survive
Whole-blob overwrite	lost pref	per-key entries	preserved
Pref doesn't sync	wrong scope	classify as account-scoped	follows user
Device pref synced (annoying)	wrong scope	keep device-scoped local	per-device
Personalization without consent	privacy review	gate on consent	compliant
Account switch	per-account	load that account's prefs	correct



> **Classify first, then sync:** the most common preference bug is wrong scoping — a device setting that shouldn't sync syncing (changing all devices), or an account setting that should sync staying local. Decide device vs account per preference.

43.10 Scaling the Implementation

- **Level 1.** Device-local prefs only (DataStore, Ch 4) — no sync.

- **Level 2.** Account-scoped prefs synced offline-first (Ch 29/31/32); per-key LWW (Ch 33); per-account (Ch 42).
- **Level 3 — production.** Precedence model; set-merge for collection prefs; global- state exposure (Ch 39); consent-gated personalization; apply instantly app-wide.
- **Level 4 — large.** Personalization signals feeding backend recs (Ch 73); fine- grained privacy controls; preference schema versioning (Ch 16); many prefs.
- **Level 5 — enterprise.** Managed/policy-driven preferences, cross-platform preference sync, preference audit, differential-privacy personalization, GDPR export/delete of preferences (Ch 37).

Avoid overengineering: many apps only need device-local settings (DataStore). Add account sync when users genuinely use multiple devices and expect settings to follow — and only sync account-scoped prefs.

43.11 Alternative Approaches and Trade-offs

Dimension	Option A	Option B	When
Scope	Account-scoped (synced)	device-scoped (local)	Account for user-level prefs; device for device-specific
Storage	Per-key entries	one blob	Per-key (concurrent edits survive, conflict per key); blob only for atomic small config
Conflict	Per-key LWW / set-merge (Ch 33)	whole-blob LWW	Per-key — blob loses concurrent edits
Sync	Offline-first (Ch 29)	fetch-on-read	Offline-first (instant local); fetch loses offline
Prefs source	User preferences (user-controlled)	remote config (server-controlled, Ch 41)	Don't conflate — different control/ownership
Personalization	Consent-gated, minimized	collect freely	Consent + minimization (privacy/legal)

User preferences vs remote config (the key distinction): both are "settings" but opposite in control. **User preferences** are set by the *user* and sync to the *user's* account (theme, filters); **remote config/flags** (Ch 41) are set by the *operator* and pushed to *clients* (rollout, tuning). Store and sync them separately; a user preference goes to the user's synced pref store, a flag comes from remote config. Conflating them (e.g., overwriting a user's choice with a server default) breaks UX.

Per-key vs blob storage: storing each preference as its own keyed entry lets concurrent edits to different prefs both survive and allows per-key conflict policies (LWW vs set-merge); a single JSON blob is simpler but a whole-blob LWW loses one device's concurrent change. Use per-key for synced prefs.

43.12 Security & Privacy Considerations

- **Personalization signals are sensitive** — "not interested," viewing history, preferred categories reveal interests/behavior. **Gate on consent** (GDPR/CCPA); **minimize** what's collected/synced; let users view/clear them (Ch 37).

- **Per-account scoping** (Ch 42) — one user's preferences/personalization must not leak to another on a shared device.
- **Encrypt sensitive synced prefs** at rest (Ch 24) if they reveal personal data.
- **Clear on logout** (Ch 22) — account prefs/personalization are user data.
- **Export/delete** preferences for data-subject rights (Ch 37).
- **Backend authorizes** pref reads/writes per account; the client can't read another account's synced prefs.
- Client vs backend: the client applies prefs for UX; the backend stores the authoritative account preferences and must scope them per user, honoring consent.

43.13 Performance and Resource Optimization

- **Instant local apply** (optimistic) — settings change immediately; sync is background.
- **Observe as global state** (Ch 39) — prefs read app-wide from a conflated `StateFlow`; theme/filters apply without refetch.
- **Per-key entries + delta sync** (Ch 32) — sync only changed prefs, not the whole set.
- **Debounce rapid changes** (a slider) before enqueuing (Ch 31 compaction).
- **Device prefs stay local** — no sync cost for device-specific settings.
- **Profiling:** pref-sync volume/frequency, apply latency, pref store size, personalization-signal volume.

43.14 Testing Strategy

Fakes + in-memory Room; test scope classification, precedence, conflict, consent.

```
class PreferenceSyncTest {
    @Test fun `account pref applies optimistically and queues sync`() = runTest {
        repo.setTheme(Theme.Dark)
        assertEquals(Theme.Dark, repo.theme.first())          // instant
        assertEquals(1, outbox.pending().size)                // queued (Ch 31)
    }
    @Test fun `device pref does not sync`() = runTest {
        device.setTextScale(1.2f)
        assertEquals(0, outbox.pending().size)                // local only
    }
    @Test fun `precedence: synced over default`() = runTest {
        dao.upsert(prefEntry("theme", "Dark"))
        assertEquals(Theme.Dark, repo.theme.first())          // not the System default
    }
    @Test fun `scalar conflict uses LWW`() {
        val r = resolver.resolve("theme", base = e("theme","System",v=0), local =
e("theme","Dark",v=1), remote = e("theme","Light",v=2))
        assertEquals("Light", r.value)                        // higher version
    }
    @Test fun `collection conflict merges sets`() {
        val r = resolver.resolve("muted_topics", base = e("muted_topics","[]",0),
            local = e("muted_topics","[\"a\"]",1), remote = e("muted_topics","[\"b\"]",1))
        assertTrue(r.value.contains("a") && r.value.contains("b"))   // both survive
    }
    @Test fun `personalization gated by consent`() = runTest {
        repo.recordNotInterested("x", consent = DeniedConsent)
        assertEquals(0, outbox.pending().size)                // not recorded
    }
    @Test fun `prefs scoped per account`() = runTest {
        accounts.switchTo("A"); repo.setTheme(Theme.Dark)
        accounts.switchTo("B"); assertNotEquals(Theme.Dark, repo.theme.first())
    }
}
```

What to test: scope classification (device vs account), precedence, per-key LWW + set- merge conflict, consent gating, per-account isolation, offline optimistic apply.

43.15 Production Observability

- **Metrics:** pref-sync success/failure, cross-device apply latency (phone → TV), conflict rate + resolution outcomes, personalization opt-in rate, pref-sync volume, default-vs-synced read distribution.
- **Logs:** `pref{key, scope, synced}` (no values — may reveal interests, Ch 28), `pref_conflict{key, resolution}`.

- **Debugging:** pref didn't follow to another device → wrong scope (device not account) / sync failing; concurrent change lost → whole-blob not per-key; device setting changed all devices → wrongly account-scoped; personalization without consent → consent gate missing; wrong account's prefs → not per-account scoped.
- **Alerting:** personalization-without-consent → privacy incident.
- **Privacy:** personalization signals are sensitive — redact; consent; export/delete (Ch 37).

43.16 System Design Interview Preparation

> ≥25 questions.

Fundamentals

1. *Device- vs account-scoped prefs?* Device-specific (don't sync: per-device text size) vs user-level (sync: theme, filters).
2. *Why does scope matter?* Syncing the wrong one is annoying (changes all devices) or wrong (doesn't follow user).
3. *Precedence?* local-unsynced → synced → default.
4. *How sync account prefs?* Offline-first (Ch 29): optimistic + outbox (Ch 31) + delta (Ch 32).
5. *User prefs vs remote config?* User-controlled (sync to account) vs server- controlled (rolled out, Ch 41) — don't conflate.

Conflict

6. *Preference conflict?* Same pref edited on two devices.
7. *Resolution?* Per-key LWW (scalars) or set-merge/OR-Set (collections, Ch 33).
8. *Why per-key not blob?* Concurrent edits to different prefs both survive; blob LWW loses one.
9. *Muted topics conflict?* Set-merge (both devices' adds/removes survive).

Storage/scope

10. *Where device prefs?* Local DataStore (Ch 4), never synced.
11. *Where account prefs?* Synced store (Room offline-first), per-account (Ch 42).
12. *Per-account?* Scope by accountId; clear on logout (Ch 42/22).

Personalization

13. *What are personalization signals?* Viewing/liking/skipping, preferred categories — sensitive.
14. *Privacy?* Consent-gated, minimized, exportable/deletable (Ch 37).
15. *Feeds what?* Backend recommendations (Ch 73).

Correctness

16. *Offline edit?* Optimistic local + outbox; syncs later.
17. *Edit during sync?* Version + conflict resolve (Ch 33).
18. *Account switch mid-edit?* Account-scoped + flatMapLatest (Ch 42).

Exposure

19. *How consumed app-wide?* Global state holder (Ch 39); applies instantly.
20. *Apply latency?* Instant local (optimistic); cross-device via sync.

Security

21. *Encrypt synced prefs?* If sensitive (Ch 24).
22. *Who authorizes?* Backend per account.
23. *Export/delete prefs?* GDPR (Ch 37).

Testing

24. *How test scope?* Device pref doesn't queue sync; account pref does.
25. *How test conflict?* LWW for scalar; merge for collection.
26. *How test consent?* Denied → not recorded.

Production debugging

27. *Pref didn't follow device?* Wrong scope / sync failing.
28. *Concurrent change lost?* Whole-blob not per-key.
29. *Device setting changed all devices?* Wrongly account-scoped.

Design-change challenges

1. **Theme must follow the user across devices.** Account-scoped synced pref.
2. **Text size should stay per-device.** Device-scoped local (don't sync).
3. **Muted topics edited on two devices.** Set-merge CRDT (Ch 33).
4. **Personalization must respect consent.** Gate on consent; minimize; export/delete.
5. **Per-account preferences.** accountId scoping (Ch 42).

Mock walkthrough (abridged)

Clarify (which prefs, multi-device, personalization, privacy?) → classify device vs account → device-local (DataStore) vs account-synced (offline-first, Ch 29) → per-key entries + conflict (LWW/set-merge, Ch 33) → precedence (local-unsynced→synced→default) → per-account (Ch 42) → global-state exposure (Ch 39) → consent for personalization → distinguish from remote config (Ch 41) → testing.

43.17 Practical Exercises

1. **Beginner.** Classify and store: text-size (device-local) and theme (account- synced); prove theme queues a sync and text-size doesn't. *Eval:* correct scoping.
2. **Intermediate.** Sync account prefs offline-first (optimistic + outbox + delta); apply instantly + follow to another device. *Eval:* instant; cross-device.
3. **Advanced.** Add per-key conflict resolution (LWW for theme, set-merge for muted topics); prove concurrent edits resolve correctly. *Eval:* scalar LWW; set survives.

4. **Production debugging.** Fix a pref that doesn't follow the user (wrong scope) and a whole-blob sync that loses concurrent edits (per-key). *Eval:* follows; both survive.
5. **System design challenge.** Add consent-gated personalization signals feeding recs (Ch 73) with export/delete (Ch 37). *Eval:* consent honored; exportable/deletable.

(Solutions withheld unless requested.)

43.18 Chapter Summary & Reference Sheet

Key decisions: classify each preference as **device-scoped** (local DataStore, don't sync — per-device settings) or **account-scoped** (synced, follows the user); sync account prefs **offline-first** (optimistic + outbox + delta, Ch 29/31/32) with **per-key conflict resolution** (**LWW** for scalars, **set-merge/OR-Set** for collections, Ch 33) stored as **per-key entries** (not a blob); resolve reads by **precedence** (local-unsynced → synced → default); scope **per account** (Ch 42); expose as **observable global state** (Ch 39) applied instantly; treat **personalization signals** as sensitive (**consent**, minimization, export/delete Ch 37); and keep **user preferences distinct from remote config** (Ch 41 — user-controlled vs server- controlled).

Concepts: device- vs account-scoped prefs, precedence model, offline-first pref sync, per-key vs blob, per-key LWW/set-merge conflict, personalization signals + consent, user-prefs-vs-remote-config, global-state exposure.

Common mistakes: wrong scope (device setting syncs, or account setting doesn't); whole-blob LWW (loses concurrent edits); no precedence model; conflating user prefs with remote config; syncing personalization without consent; not per-account scoping; unencrypted sensitive synced prefs.

Checklist:

- [ ] classify device vs account
- [ ] device-local (DataStore)
- [ ] account-synced offline-first (Ch 29)
- [ ] per-key entries
- [ ] per-key conflict (LWW/set-merge, Ch 33)
- [ ] precedence local-unsynced→synced→default
- [ ] per-account (Ch 42)
- [ ] global-state exposure (Ch 39)
- [ ] consent-gated personalization
- [ ] export/delete (Ch 37)
- [ ] distinct from remote config (Ch 41).

Key APIs/patterns: DataStore (device, Ch 4), account-pref Room entries (per-key, per-account Ch 42), offline-first sync (Ch 29/31/32), `PrefConflictResolver` (LWW/ OR-Set, Ch 33), precedence resolution, `PreferencesRepository` global state (Ch 39), consent gating.

References:

- Settings / DataStore: https://developer.android.com/develop/ui/views/components/settings
- Offline-first data layer: https://developer.android.com/topic/architecture/data-layer/offline-first
- Privacy best practices: https://developer.android.com/privacy-and-security/security-tips

- (composes) Ch 4 DataStore, Ch 29–33 Sync/Conflict, Ch 39 Global State, Ch 41 Remote Config, Ch 42 Multi-Account, Ch 37 Export/Delete

Chapter review (Phase 4)

- **Completeness:** all 18 sections; architecture/class/sequence/failure diagrams; device/account stores + precedence + per-key conflict + consent; concurrency (per-key resolution, account scope); failure (wrong scope, blob loss, consent); 5 levels; user-prefs-vs-remote-config and per-key-vs-blob trade-offs; privacy (consent/ minimize/export); perf (instant apply, delta); scope/precedence/conflict tests; observability (cross-device latency); 29 Q&A + 5 challenges. ✅
- **Expand later:** recommendations (Ch 73), export/delete (Ch 37), accessibility (Ch 96), theming (Ch 97). **Completes Part V (Ch 38–43).**
- **Interview coverage:** exceeds ≥25 bar.